

Kalahari desert

The Kalahari is a huge, dry, sandy area in southern Africa. In some parts of the Kalahari, it may not rain for up to eight months. Many animals here have to travel in search of fresh grass to eat, and predators follow them.

Sociable weaver

These small birds build giant nests, over 21 ft (6 m) wide, with up to 100 weavers in each one. Some nests are so heavy that they break the tree they're in!



Sociable weavers' massive nests can last for 100 years.



Location

The Kalahari covers most of Botswana and parts of Namibia and South Africa. In summer, it can become as hot as 104°F (40°C).



HABITAT KEY

- Wetlands
- Scrublands
- Tropical grasslands
- Hot desert

SCALE

0 100 miles
0 100 kilometers

ANGOLA

Okavango

Circling high in the desert sky on its broad wings, this bird searches for dead animals to eat.



White-backed vulture



Ostrich

Growing up to 9 ft (2.8 m) tall, the ostrich is the world's largest bird. It can't fly, but it can outrun most of its predators.

Windhoek

Warthogs kneel on their front legs when munching on fresh grass.



Common warthog



Springbok

This high-leaping antelope moves around in large herds. Both males and females have horns.

BOTSWANA



Aardvark

The aardvark's name means "earth pig." It can eat up to 50,000 ants a night!

During the day, this large rodent sleeps in caves or burrows. At night, it comes out to find plants to eat.



Cape porcupine

African bullfrog

This big frog lives underground during the dry season, which can last 10 months of each year!



Bloemfontein

Meerkat

Meerkats help each other protect their families. They take turns standing on guard and warn other meerkats if danger approaches.

Gaborone

Pretoria

Cheetah

The world's fastest land animal, the cheetah can run at speeds of up to 68 mph (110 kph). It takes just three seconds for this cat to reach its top speed.



NAMIBIA

SOUTH AFRICA

Vaal

